

By Kat Lonsdorf

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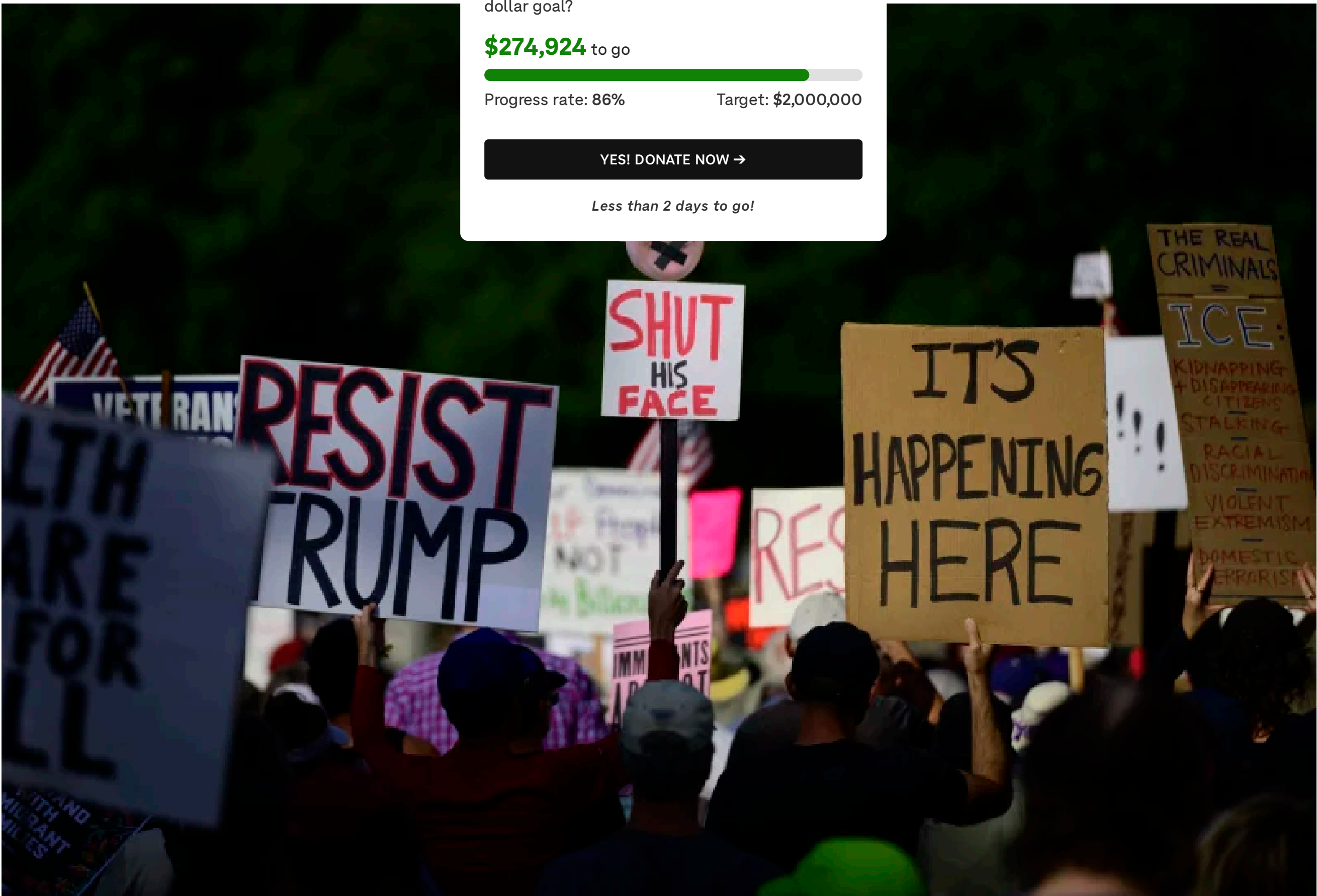
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People hold signs during a protest on Sunday in Portland, Ore.
Mathieu Lewis-Rolland/Getty Images

President Trump says he has ordered the deployment of troops to Portland, Ore., and that he's authorized them to use "full force" to curb protests outside U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement facilities.

It's the latest instance of Trump deploying the military to various cities that he says are plagued with crime, with federal troops also expected to arrive in Memphis, Tenn., this week.

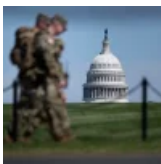
On Monday, Illinois Gov. JB Pritzker said the Department of Homeland Security is also looking to send troops to Chicago for protection of ICE agents and facilities, member station WBEZ reported. The governor added that the Illinois National Guard received a memo indicating that DHS requested about 100 military personnel. DHS and ICE did not respond to WBEZ's request for comment.



We break down what's going on, how officials in Portland and Memphis are responding, and how this fits into a larger picture.

1. Expect another legal fight

Like many of Trump's announcements, the Portland push started with a post on Saturday on his social media platform, Truth Social. He called Portland "war ravaged" — which is not the case on the ground there — and said he had authorized the Pentagon to provide troops.



NATIONAL

NPR-Ipsos poll: Americans don't broadly support Trump's National Guard deployments

"I am directing Secretary of War, Pete Hegseth, to provide all necessary Troops to protect War ravaged Portland, and any of our ICE Facilities under siege from attack by Antifa, and other domestic terrorists," Trump wrote in the post. "I am also authorizing Full Force, if necessary."

It was unclear from that post what troops he meant. NPR reached out to the Pentagon for clarity on Saturday, and a U.S. official who was not authorized to speak publicly said the Pentagon had not issued a deployment order for Portland and that it only learned of Trump's request from the media. That official also said it would be likely that National Guard troops would be used.

All of this comes after there were reports of a ramp-up of federal officers at an ICE facility in Portland on Friday, which Mayor Keith Wilson called a show of force and told residents to remain calm and not react.



Federal agents confront protesters outside the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement building on Sunday in Portland, Ore.

Mathieu Lewis-Rolland/Getty Images

By Sunday, Oregon Public Broadcasting (OPB) reported that the Trump administration called 200 members of the Oregon National Guard into federal service for a 60-day deployment, according to a memo from the Department of Defense to Gov. Tina Kotek. And hundreds of protesters gathered outside Portland's ICE facility late into Sunday night.

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PRINTABLE CHAIR YOGA FOR SENIORS

DAY 1 10 min. Mountain Pose 5 min. Cat-Cow Stretch 10 min. Seated Forward Bend	DAY 2 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend	DAY 3 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend 10 min. Seated Twist
DAY 4 REST	DAY 5 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend	DAY 6 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend
DAY 7 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend	DAY 8 REST	DAY 9 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend
DAY 10 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend	DAY 11 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend	DAY 12 REST
DAY 13 REST	DAY 14 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend	DAY 15 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend
DAY 16 10 min. Seated Twist 10 min. Seated Forward Bend 10 min. Seated Side Bend	DAY 17 REST	NEXT DAY →

Both the governor of Oregon and the mayor of Portland dispute Trump's claims that the city is unsafe or in need of troops and have been urging residents to remain peaceful. OPB reported Sunday that Oregon's top officials and the city of Portland were filing a federal lawsuit arguing that the administration had overreached and acted unlawfully. In a press conference Saturday, Mayor Keith Wilson said the necessary troops needed for the city is zero.

"This is an American city. We do not need any intervention. This is not a military target," he said.

2. Trump has been making these kinds of threats for months

In Washington, D.C., where Trump has federal control, more than 2,000 National Guard troops from a variety of states have been deployed for more than a month in what Trump has said is an effort to crack down on crime.

Back in June, Trump also federalized California's National Guard against Gov. Gavin Newsom's wishes and deployed them along with the Marines to Los Angeles to quell protests against ICE deportations there. That sounds similar to what could happen in Portland.



In a Truth Social post on Saturday, President Trump said he authorized the deployment of military troops to Portland.

Kevin Dietsch/Getty Images

And then there are a handful of cities that Trump has threatened — about a dozen at this point, all Democratically led. Places like Chicago, where he also used the war metaphor but has yet to actually send troops.

Earlier this month, Trump posted online that Chicago was "about to find out why it's called the Department of WAR," referencing his call to rename the Defense Department.

And then there is Memphis. Trump has authorized the use of the National Guard there as part of a similar crackdown, along with other federal agents who are all expected to start arriving as early as this week.



LAW
Judge rules against National Guard in LA, and Trump vows to send them to Chicago

The Trump administration has described Memphis as "suffering from tremendous levels of violent crime that have overwhelmed its local government's ability to respond effectively."

Memphis, which is the second-biggest city in Tennessee, is run by a Democratic mayor. Meanwhile, Republican Tennessee Gov. Bill Lee has said he not only welcomed federal assistance, but that he has been in "constant communication" with the Trump administration for months about a plan to curb crime in Memphis using federal and state resources.

3. A larger picture is becoming clear

The National Guard is not trained for community policing or to make arrests, and that's not how they're generally used. In Washington, D.C., they've mainly been patrolling federal property and beautifying city parks.



National Guard members weed an area as they clean up a park in Washington, D.C., on Sept. 18.
Jim Watson/AFP via Getty Images

Yet Trump says these National Guard deployments are to deal with crime. And he also has been conflating the work of troops with wider immigration and deportation efforts. We've seen that in Washington, D.C., for example, where ICE agents moved in along with the National Guard deployment and started detaining people at high rates.

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PRINTABLE CHAIR YOGA FOR SENIORS

DAY 1 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min knee stretch 10 min torso twist	DAY 2 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist	DAY 3 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist
DAY 4 REST	DAY 5 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist	DAY 6 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist
DAY 7 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist	DAY 8 REST	DAY 9 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist
DAY 10 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist	DAY 11 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist	DAY 12 REST
DAY 13 REST	DAY 14 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist	DAY 15 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist
DAY 16 10 min side stretch 10 min shoulder stretch 10 min torso twist	DAY 17 REST	NEXT DAY

Legal experts have also said that another part of this that has them worried is the normalization of troops — sometimes armed — on U.S. streets.

POLITICS

Trump is deploying the National Guard to Memphis. Experts worry it's becoming normal

The U.S. has a long history of limiting the role of the military domestically, and experts say these kinds of continued threats and deployments challenge laws that are centuries old and central to the ideas that the U.S. was founded on.

We have unpacked more about what experts tell us in this piece, and you can find more of our coverage on this wider issue here:

- Trump walks back Chicago 'war' threat, but vows to 'clean up' cities

- How Chicago, Baltimore and New Orleans are reacting to Trump's National Guard threats
- Judge rules against National Guard in LA, and Trump vows to send them to Chicago

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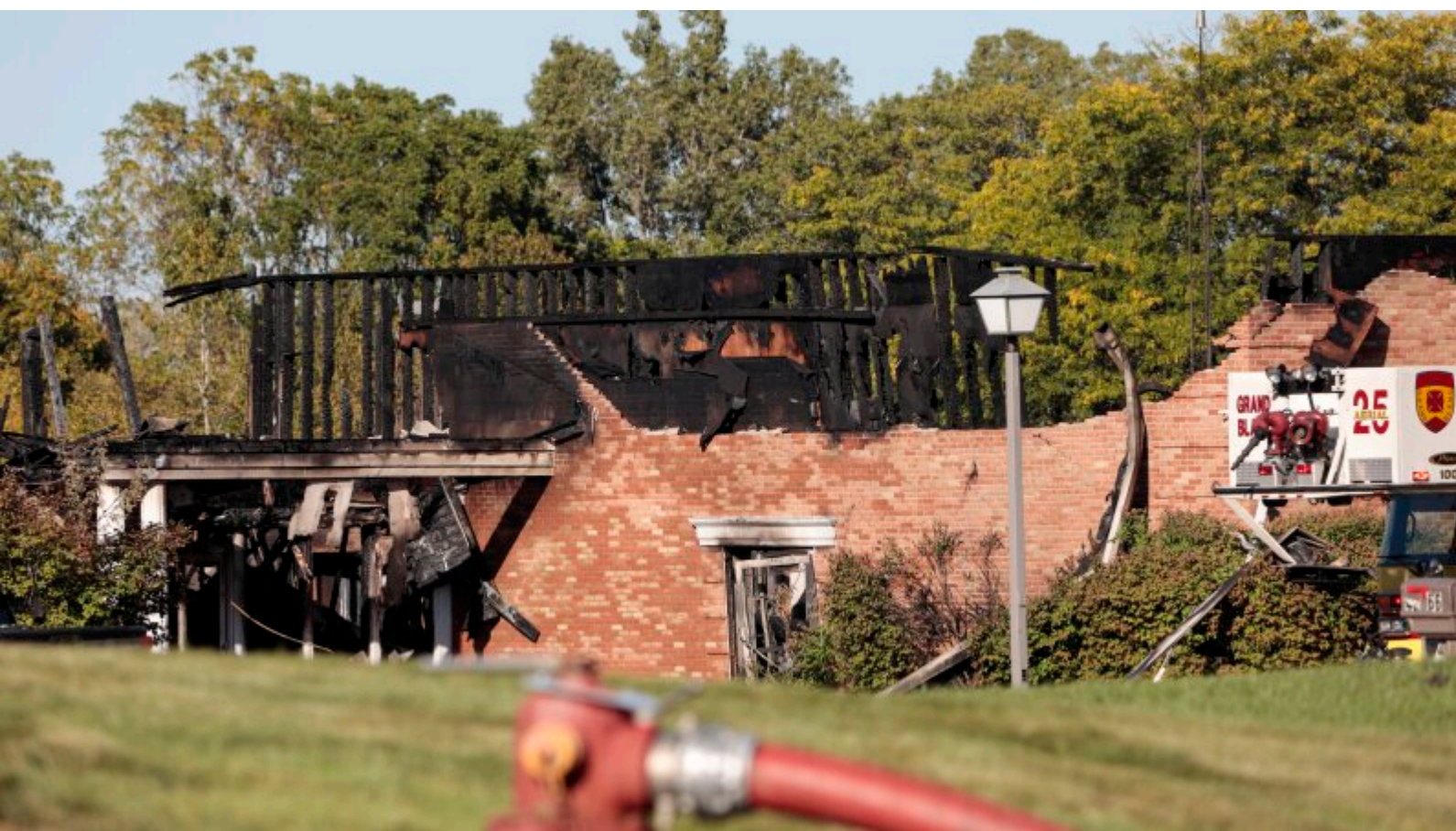
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PRINTABLE CHAIR YOGA FOR SENIORS



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DAY 4 REST	DAY 5 - Seated Cat-Cow - Seated Bridge - Seated Side Bends	DAY 6 - Seated Cat-Cow - Seated Bridge - Seated Side Bends
DAY 7 - Seated Forward Fold - Seated Knee Pull-Flare - Seated Twists	DAY 8 REST	DAY 9 - Seated Cat-Cow - Seated Bridge - Seated Side Bends
DAY 10 - Seated Cat-Cow - Seated Bridge - Seated Side Bends	DAY 11 - Seated Cat-Cow - Seated Bridge - Seated Side Bends	DAY 12 REST
DAY 13 REST	DAY 14 - Seated Cat-Cow - Seated Bridge - Seated Side Bends	DAY 15 - Seated Cat-Cow - Seated Bridge - Seated Side Bends
DAY 16 - Seated Cat-Cow - Seated Bridge - Seated Side Bends	DAY 17 REST	NEXT DAY →

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